

MARKETING MIX & MEDIA EFFECTIVENESS

H1 FY2026 Marketing Mix & Media Effectiveness Review

A&P; allocation, retail-media incrementality, and the two-speed brand model

Document type Marketing mix & media effectiveness review

Period H1 FY2026

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A&P; spend (H1 FY26)	\$10.9M (Q1) + \$11.7M (Q2) = \$22.6M
Crunchwell model	~\$48.7M/yr, TV-heavy (Linear TV \$24M)
ProteinPeak model	~\$22.2M/yr, digital/creator (Paid Social \$7.8M)
Retail-media incrementality	\$0.65 per \$1 blended · Walmart 1.20 vs Amazon 0.40
Headline call	Fund what works per brand; fix the Amazon-Ads drag

Executive summary

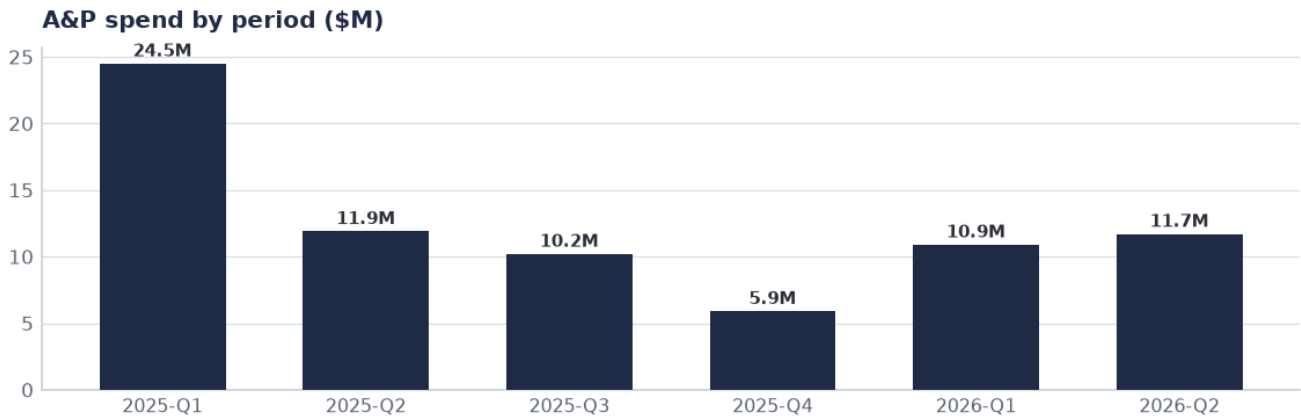
Acme runs a two-speed marketing model, and the effectiveness read says both speeds are broadly right for their brand — with one clear fix. Crunchwell spends ~\$48.7M a year on a traditional, TV-heavy plan (\$24M Linear TV); ProteinPeak spends ~\$22.2M on a digital, creator-led plan (\$7.8M Paid Social, \$2.86M Influencer) and is winning the social conversation (+0.44 sentiment). H1 A&P; totals \$22.6M. The sharpest finding is in retail media: the blended return is \$0.65 incremental per \$1, dragged down by Amazon Ads (0.40) while Walmart Connect (1.20) more than pays back. Fix the Amazon drag and the working-media dollar improves without new budget.

- **H1 A&P; is \$22.6M** (\$10.9M in Q1, \$11.7M in Q2) — the spend steps up into the ProteinPeak launch quarter.
- **Two-speed model:** Crunchwell is TV-first (Linear TV = ~\$24M, ~half its plan); ProteinPeak is social-first (Paid Social \$7.8M) and creator-led (Influencer \$2.86M).
- **Retail media returns \$0.65/\$1 blended** — Walmart Connect 1.20 and Kroger 0.77 carry it; Amazon Ads (0.40) is a drag on \$2.4M of spend.
- **Creators are working for ProteinPeak:** +0.44 social sentiment vs Crunchwell's -0.11 — the digital model is buying relevance the TV model isn't (see Report 29).

1 · A&P; scorecard

A&P; H1 FY26 \$22.6M Q1 + Q2	CRUNCHWELL A&P; \$48.7M TV-heavy, /yr	PROTEINPEAK A&P; \$22.2M digital, /yr	RETAIL MEDIA ROI \$0.65 incr. per \$1
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A&P; by period steps up through H1 as spend loads into the ProteinPeak launch (26Q2 \$11.7M). The strategic question for this review is not the level but the mix: whether each brand's channel plan matches how its shoppers actually buy — and whether the working-media dollar is returning incremental volume.



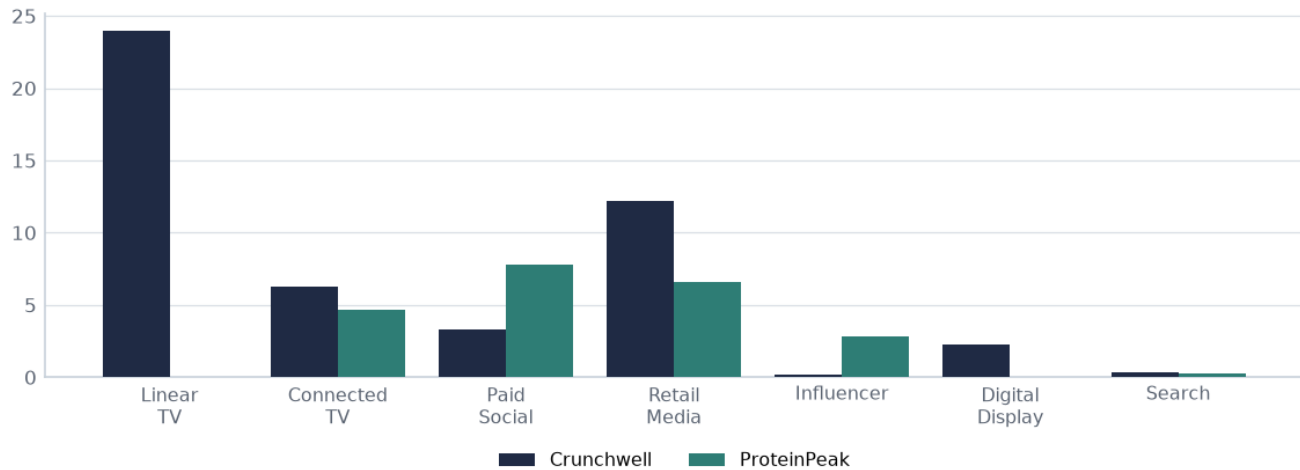
A&P; steps back up in H1 FY26 (26Q1 \$10.9M, 26Q2 \$11.7M) after the FY25 taper, funding the ProteinPeak launch.

Source: seed_marketing_spend, by period.

2 · The two-speed brand model

Crunchwell and ProteinPeak run near-opposite channel plans. Crunchwell is traditional and TV-led — Linear TV alone is ~\$24M, roughly half the brand's A&P; with Retail Media and CTV next. ProteinPeak is digital and creator-led — Paid Social is the largest line (\$7.8M), followed by Retail Media and CTV, with a meaningful Influencer investment (\$2.86M) that Crunchwell essentially does not run. This is a deliberate segmentation: reach-and-frequency for the established flagship, culture-and-creators for the growth engine.

A&P channel mix — Crunchwell vs ProteinPeak (\$M/yr)



Crunchwell is TV-first (Linear TV ~\$24M); ProteinPeak is social-first (\$7.8M) with real influencer spend. Two brands, two media models.

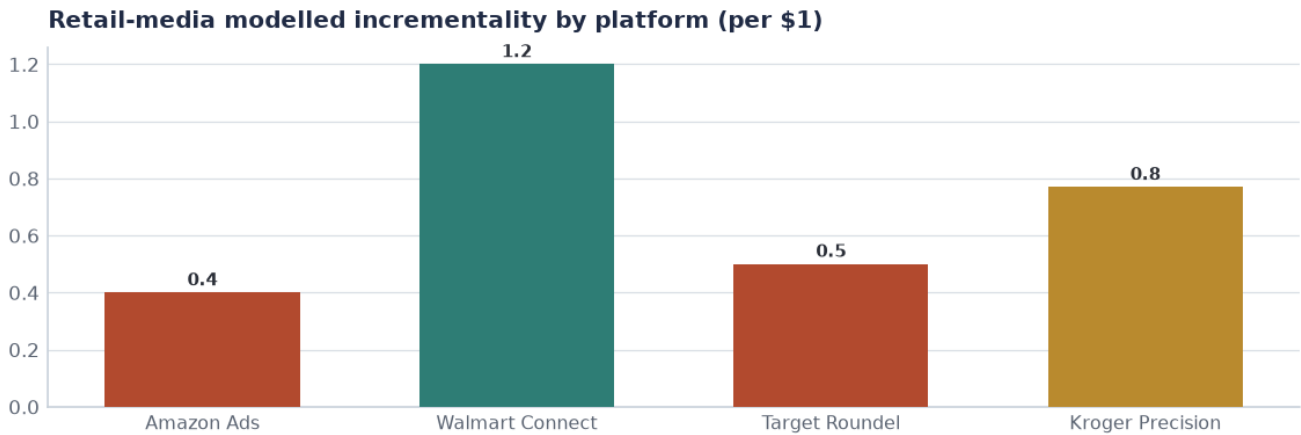
Source: seed_marketing_spend, by brand × channel.

3 · Retail-media incrementality — the fixable drag

Retail media is where the read is sharpest and the fix is clearest. Platform-reported ROAS flatters every platform; the modelled incrementality ratio tells the real story. Walmart Connect returns 1.20 incremental per \$1 and Kroger Precision 0.77 — both carrying the portfolio. Amazon Ads returns 0.40 on the largest single spend line (\$2.4M), and Target Roundel 0.50. The blended return is \$0.65 per \$1. The Amazon drag is the fixable problem: much of that spend is defending base volume the shopper would have bought anyway.

Platform	Spend	Incremental	Reported ROAS	Modelled incr.	Call
Amazon Ads	\$2.4M	\$1.0M	1.12	0.40	Reallocate
Walmart Connect	\$1.0M	\$1.2M	2.06	1.20	Reinvest
Target Roundel	\$0.4M	\$0.2M	1.16	0.50	Reallocate
Kroger Precision	\$0.4M	\$0.3M	1.43	0.77	Hold

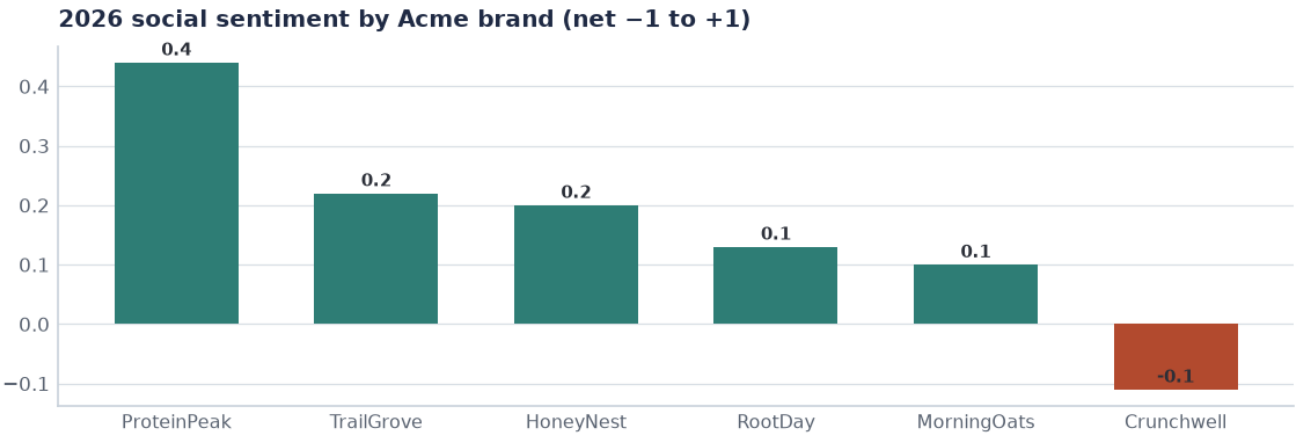
Source: seed_retail_media_spend_q1_2026 (Tasha Brooks). Modelled incrementality ≠ platform ROAS.



Walmart Connect (1.20) is the only platform above breakeven; Amazon Ads (0.40) is the drag. Blended return \$0.65 per \$1.

4 · Creators & the relevance dividend

The digital / creator model is buying something the TV model is not: cultural relevance, visible in social sentiment. ProteinPeak runs +0.44 net sentiment on ~496 mentions in 2026 — the strongest of any Acme brand — while Crunchwell sits at -0.11 on 316 mentions. The \$2.86M ProteinPeak influencer line is a small share of A&P; but is doing outsized work on the relevance metric that the brand-equity tracker (Report 29) flags as Crunchwell's core weakness. The read is not 'spend more on TV' or 'spend more on social' universally — it is 'buy relevance where relevance is the problem'.



ProteinPeak (+0.44) leads on sentiment; Crunchwell (-0.11) is the only Acme brand underwater. The creator model is buying relevance.

Source: social_mentions, Sentiment_-1to1, calendar 2026.

5 · The media call

Cross-reference: eComm / retail media and the CFO read

The retail-media reallocation detailed here feeds the eComm / retail-media plan (Report 34) and the CFO effectiveness read (Report 40). The proposed H2 move is to shift ~\$700K out of Amazon Ads into Walmart Connect, Kroger, and the Louisiana recovery (a ~2.2× ROI lane) — a reallocation, not a budget increase.

Recommendations & next steps

#	Action	Owner	When
1	Reallocate H2 retail media out of Amazon Ads (0.40) into Walmart Connect (1.20), Kroger, and LA — planning estimate ~\$700K shift, no net budget increase.	Tasha Brooks	H2 planning
2	Hold Crunchwell's TV-led plan but test shifting marginal dollars to CTV/social to buy the relevance the equity tracker (Report 29) is flagging.	Hugo Lin / CMO office	H2
3	Protect and scale the ProteinPeak creator model (\$2.86M influencer) behind the launch and the Q3 Chocolate Almond concept.	Sage Park / Hugo Lin	Q3
4	Report modelled incrementality — not platform ROAS — as the retail-media KPI in the CFO read (Report 40).	Trade Finance / CMO office	Next MBR